

68.3 "EITHER... OR," "NEITHER... NOR," AND "BOTH... AND"

"Either... or" and "neither... nor" are used to compare options, usually noun phrases, prepositional phrases, or clauses.

I want **either** the cake **or** the cookie.



Neither the cake **nor** the cookie tasted good.



"Nor" can only be used with "neither."

"Neither" is only used with a positive verb.

"Either... or" and "neither... nor" can be used with two or more options.

The first two options are separated with a comma.

I want to play **either** tennis, badminton, **or** squash.



Neither basketball, golf, **nor** hockey are the sports for me.



"Both... and" is the opposite of "neither... nor," but can only be used with two options.

I want **both** the cake **and** the cookie.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

We'll meet up on **either** Tuesday **or** Wednesday.



My teacher told me I could **neither** paint **nor** draw.



I invited **both** my grandmother **and** my uncle.



I'm going to play **either** tennis, basketball, **or** hockey tonight.



Neither sports **nor** exercise interest me.



I went to **both** the bakery **and** the butcher shop.

